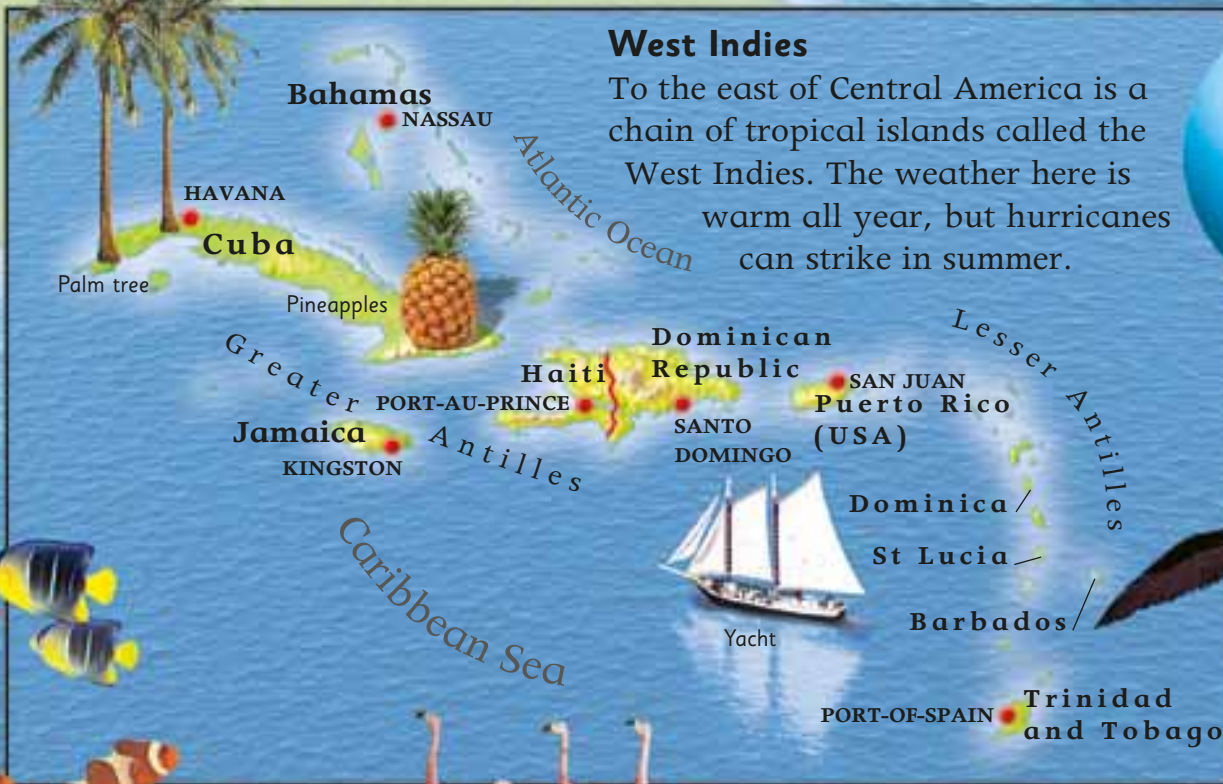


Mexico and Central America

West Indies

To the east of Central America is a chain of tropical islands called the West Indies. The weather here is warm all year, but hurricanes can strike in summer.



Flamingos

Chichén Itzá

Coral reef

Olmec head

Macaw

Green turtle

Grapefruit

Bananas

Hands on

Cut the leafy top off a pineapple and plant it in a pot of soil. If you keep it in a greenhouse, it will grow into a pineapple plant.

Belize

BELMOPAN

Guatemala Honduras

GUATEMALA CITY

TEGUCIGALPA

El Salvador

SAN SALVADOR

Nicaragua

MANAGUA

Lake Nicaragua

Costa Rica

SAN JOSÉ

Panama

Panama Canal

Spider monkey

PANAMA CITY

Toucan



Panama Canal

The man-made Panama Canal links the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans. About 12,000 ships pass through it every year, making it one of the world's busiest waterways.

As hooks to hang from branches.